Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Zambia unlocks digital earnings for creators** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026 ZAMBIA

  Zambia's technology and youth ministries are developing a framework for local content creators to earn from digital platforms, and are talking to Meta, TikTok and Google about the legal and technical arrangements. The President named it a priority when opening the 14th National Assembly, and a national database of creators is being compiled. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **TASIS outlines governance plans for 24 million Sudanese** — The Sudan Times, 12 October 2026 SUDAN

  The prime minister of Sudan's TASIS-backed administration announced plans for a national smart identity card for banking, judicial and administrative transactions in the territory it runs, alongside new vehicle registration, licensing and customs procedures. He put that territory at about 90 localities and 24 million people, figures that are not independently verified. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS*.

- **Mozambique: Government updating national cybersecurity strategy** — Club of Mozambique, 12 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Mozambique's communications minister said the national cybersecurity strategy for 2026 to 2030 is being updated and will be the main instrument for implementing the Cybersecurity Act. He put cyber incidents recorded in 2025 at about 39,600 and urged operators of critical infrastructure to set up their incident response teams. *Also under Cybersecurity*.

- **Mozambique Regulator Pushes Postal Sector Reform to Tackle Informal Deliveries** — Tech Africa News, 12 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Mozambique's communications regulator held its first postal operators forum on 9 October and called for the sector to be formalised and modernised as e-commerce grows. The country has 38 licensed postal operators, and the regulator named unlicensed delivery through digital platforms as a problem for oversight and consumer protection. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **Government gives postal sector 90 days for transformation plan** — The Herald, 12 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister gave her ministry, the regulator and the postal operator 90 days to produce a costed plan for the postal and courier sector to 2030, with quarterly reporting. She also directed operators to comply with the Cyber and Data Protection Act and required pilots of artificial intelligence and drones to carry a named lead, a timetable and measurable benefits. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Access to services*.

- **Chad moves towards adopting its national artificial intelligence strategy | East African Policy Observer** — East African Policy Observer, 12 October 2026 CHAD

  Chad held a pre-validation workshop on its draft national artificial-intelligence strategy, drafted with the UN Economic Commission for Africa. The draft covers 2027 to 2035 and names agriculture, public administration, security and defence, education and health as priority sectors. *Also under AI.*

- **Big Tech or public good? What Cape Town's data centre battle means for residents** — Daily Maverick, 12 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  One of the organisations appealing against land-use rights for a planned hyperscale data centre in Cape Town argues that the mayor should uphold the appeal because the application did not state the site's water use, emissions or jobs. It writes that the appeal went before the city's advisory panel on 12 October and that the mayor then has 90 days to decide. *Also under Data Storage and Energy.*

- **RDC : le gouvernement annonce le lancement commercial de la 5G** — 7sur7.cd, 11 October 2026 DRC

  DR Congo's posts and telecommunications minister presented the commercial launch of 5G to the Council of Ministers on 9 October, as a new source of state revenue and a way to improve service quality. Deployment is to begin in urban areas; no operator, spectrum assignment or launch date was given. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **L'Agence — ACDD : un opérateur public au service de la transformation numérique** — Agence Centrafricaine de Développement du Digital (ACDD), 11 October 2026 CAR

  The Central African Republic's digital development agency sets out its own footing: a public industrial and commercial establishment created by a law of June 2023, with a mandate to implement the national digital strategy. The page gives no budget, staffing or activity figures. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Connectivity.*

- **Government to seek court guidance on asylum ruling, introduce registration system** — SAnews (South African Government News Agency), 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's government will ask the courts for a supervisory order on implementing the Constitutional Court's July 2026 asylum judgment. Home Affairs is to introduce an online intention-registration and appointment system by 10 November 2026, with assisted registration at Refugee Reception Offices. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Digital Identity and CRVS.*

Legislation and regulation

- **Images retouchées par l'intelligence artificielle : les limites à ne pas franchir** — La Nation (Bénin), 11 October 2026 BENIN

  A learner prosecuted for circulating altered photographs of his teacher appeared before Benin's economic crimes and terrorism court on 8 October. The newspaper sets out the digital code's penalty for publishing a doctored image of a person without consent: five years in prison and a fine of FCFA 25 million. *Also under Data protection and AI.*

- **Government to amend regulations to prevent traffic documents being used as identification** — SAnews (South African Government News Agency), 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's transport department plans to amend the road traffic regulations so that traffic register number certificates, learner's licences and driving licences no longer count as identification. A traffic register number would be valid only as long as the passport and permit it was issued on, and the draft is to be gazetted for 30 days of comment. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Registries.*

- **Department to scrap use of drivers' licences as ID** — eNCA, 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's transport minister said 300,000 dormant traffic register numbers have been blocked, about half of those found to be fraudulent. Holders of the rest have been asked to verify their details with Home Affairs, and about 8,000 have come forward. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Registries.*

- **BoG develops AI rules for financial sector** — MyJoyOnline, 11 October 2026 GHANA

  The Bank of Ghana is drafting a directive on the use of artificial intelligence by financial institutions, its governor told the banks' annual meeting. The Bank will also run thematic reviews of how banks have implemented its revised cyber and information security directive. *Also under AI and Cybersecurity.*

Data protection

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  The Ghana Health Service, supported by WHO, convened a national workshop to revise its Medical Records Strategy and Operational Guidelines, written nearly a decade ago. The revision is to cover electronic medical records, data governance, interoperability, cybersecurity and the use of artificial intelligence in healthcare. *Also under Standards, Data Exchange and Sectoral management information systems.*

- **Stellenbosch legal expert warns against Meta pay-or-consent privacy model** — The Citizen (South Africa), 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  A Stellenbosch law lecturer argues that South Africa's data-protection, consumer and competition laws are too fragmented to police platforms that make users choose between paying a subscription and surrendering personal data. The study, in a law review, calls for reform. *Also under Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **Deliberação sobre processos contravencionais** — Agência de Protecção de Dados, 11 October 2026 ANGOLA

  Angola's data protection agency publishes its register of fines: 15 sanctions between 2022 and 2026, from US$75,000 to US$525,000, with banks, telecoms operators, the national airline and the Luanda water utility among those penalised. The largest 2026 fine was for storing personal data in a cloud abroad without authorisation. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Images retouchées par l'intelligence artificielle : les limites à ne pas franchir** — La Nation (Bénin), 11 October 2026 BENIN

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

- **LESOTHO JOINED A CONTINENTAL ALLIANCE TO ADVANCE AI, DATA AND DIGITAL SKILLS PAVING THE WAY FOR THE ESTABLISHMENT OF THE SMART AFRICA DIGITAL ACADEMY. - Government of Lesotho** — Government of Lesotho, 12 October 2026 LESOTHO

  Lesotho's communications minister took part in the 21st Smart Africa Alliance meeting, and government said efforts are under way to establish the alliance's digital academy in the country. Lesotho joined the alliance in 2025. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Internet : qu'est-ce que la liaison par fibre avec la RDC peut apporter à la Centrafrique** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026 CAR DRC

The digital-economy ministers of the Central African Republic and DR Congo agreed in Moscow on 8 October on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection between the two countries, which would give the Central African Republic a third international route, toward the submarine cable landing at Moanda. No timetable or financing was announced. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **AFRINIC's proposed policy petition is a Board-absence mechanism** — BTW Media, 11 October 2026 AFRICA

  An analysis of the second draft of AFRINIC's policy-process guidelines finds that its petition route, which lets the working group seek ratification of a policy, opens only when no operative Board exists. It needs 15 supporters from three subregions and still depends on a change to the Bylaws. *Also under Public debate and participation in policymaking*.

Standards

- **Why Zim needs real-time telcom quality of service monitoring** — The Herald, 11 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  An opinion article argues that Zimbabwe's telecommunications regulator should move from periodic audits of service quality, based on operators' submitted data and scheduled drive tests, to continuous automated monitoring. It says the regulator's quarterly reports show high compliance while users experience dropped calls and outages. *Also under Connectivity and Public debate and participation in policymaking*.

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **South Sudan calls for digital governance measures at Moscow Forum** — Eye Radio, 12 October 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

  The head of South Sudan's Media Authority, leading the country's delegation at a digital forum in Moscow, said the government needs to put in place measures bringing digital technology into public administration and to understand the risks and benefits of artificial intelligence. No instrument or timetable was announced. *Also under AI*.

- **Will postcode be the next national digital rail after NIN, BVN and NIBSS?** — The Guardian Nigeria, 11 October 2026 NIGERIA

  A commentary on Nigeria's new eleven-character postcode, switched on by the postal service on 1 October, reports early users finding it accurate for some buildings and missing for others. It argues the code could serve commerce, banking and lending as a proof of address if coverage is completed. *Also under Registries*.

- **Of agents and agency — A local AI policy must work to serve us** — Daily Maverick, 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  A commentary argues that South Africa's revised artificial intelligence policy must settle who controls data, computing capacity and models, and proposes pooling them regionally. It is opinion, written as AI systems become more autonomous. *Also under AI and Digital sovereignty*.

- **Marchés publics et IA générative : le Sénégal doit fixer ses règles avant de se retrouver désarmé face à une première affaire** — OSIRIS, 11 October 2026 SENEGAL

An opinion article argues that Senegal should allow generative artificial intelligence in public procurement but require its use to be declared. The author says no Senegalese text now governs the use of artificial intelligence in public purchasing, and that the 2008 data protection law predates the technology. *Also under AI*.

- **How scammers are stealing from Ugandans** — The EastAfrican, 11 October 2026 UGANDA

  Uganda's financial services providers reported 6,533 fraud cases to regulators between January and August 2026, with about Ush23.5 billion lost of Ush67 billion targeted, on an industry consortium's figures. About 95% of reported cases involve mobile transactions, and few court cases end in conviction. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech and Cybersecurity*.

- **Why Zim needs real-time telcom quality of service monitoring** — The Herald, 11 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Summarised under Standards.

- **Stellenbosch legal expert warns against Meta pay-or-consent privacy model** — The Citizen (South Africa), 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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- **AFRINIC's proposed policy petition is a Board-absence mechanism** — BTW Media, 11 October 2026 AFRICA

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Finance

New investments

- **The World Bank Group is Leading the Charge for Private Capital Mobilization in Nigeria** — World Bank Group, 11 October 2026 NIGERIA

  The World Bank Group says it is helping mobilise up to US$5.79 billion of private financing in Nigeria in its 2026 financial year, through policy reform, investment platforms, guarantees and commercial lending. The national open-access fibre project is among the investments it names. *Also under Connectivity*.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **RDC : la 5G en préparation, près de 7 Congolais sur 10 restent hors ligne** — wearetech.africa, 12 October 2026 DRC

  DR Congo's government is preparing a commercial 5G launch, which the telecommunications minister said in late September it was working to make available before the end of 2026. The article sets that against internet use of about 30.5% of the population at the end of 2025 and mobile internet coverage of 45%. *Also under Digital divides*.

- **Botswana invests in highway connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026 BOTSWANA

  Botswana's universal service fund, working with one mobile operator, has deployed 12 mobile broadband and voice sites along the 1,900km Trans-Kalahari Highway at a cost of P34.5 million, the communications minister said. Infrastructure sharing with the other two operators is to extend coverage by the end of the next financial year. *Also under Rural digital data capture and Access to services*.

- **South Africa Wants a Digital Government. Some Government Offices Still Have Copper Internet. | Apples and Oranges** — Apples and Oranges, 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's Auditor-General found that 2,076 of about 7,800 sites on the state IT agency's network ran below 10Mbps and that 294 government facilities were still on copper, in its audit of the communications department for 2025/26. The state broadband programme also fell short of its target of 14,742 sites for the year. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Access to services.*

- **Internet : qu'est-ce que la liaison par fibre avec la RDC peut apporter à la Centrafrique** — Agence Ecofin, 12 October 2026 CAR DRC

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  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **L'Agence — ACDD : un opérateur public au service de la transformation numérique** — Agence Centrafricaine de Développement du Digital (ACDD), 11 October 2026 CAR

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data Storage

- **Big Tech or public good? What Cape Town's data centre battle means for residents** — Daily Maverick, 12 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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Energy

- **Big Tech or public good? What Cape Town's data centre battle means for residents** — Daily Maverick, 12 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Cybersecurity

- **한국 해외원조인데...코이카, 디지털 ODA로 중국 IT장비 지원** — Yonhap News Agency (연합뉴스), 12 October 2026 SENEGAL CAMEROON RWANDA EGYPT

  A South Korean MP said Korea's aid agency had supplied Chinese-made equipment to e-government projects it funded abroad, among them Senegal's National Assembly system, Egypt's public e-procurement system, Cameroon's e-procurement system and Rwanda's e-receipt and tax portal. The agency told him it has no criteria for judging whether equipment comes from a high-risk supply chain. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and China activities.*

- **Mozambique: Government updating national cybersecurity strategy** — Club of Mozambique, 12 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **How scammers are stealing from Ugandans** — The EastAfrican, 11 October 2026 UGANDA

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

- **Deliberação sobre processos contravencionais** — Agência de Protecção de Dados, 11 October 2026 ANGOLA

  Summarised under Data protection.

- **BoG develops AI rules for financial sector** — MyJoyOnline, 11 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026 GHANA

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Digital Identity and CRVS

- **6,308 NIDA cards remain uncollected in Zanzibar** — The Guardian (IPP Media), 12 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Tanzania's home affairs minister said 6,308 national identity cards printed for Zanzibar residents had not been collected. He said government is considering fines for late collection and may require the physical card for services that now accept the identity number alone. *Also under Access to services.*

- **وزارة تكنولوجيات الاتصال: تطبيقة «خدمات» متاحة للتحميل على «آبل ستور»** — Al Chourouk, 11 October 2026 TUNISIA

  Tunisia's communication technologies ministry released its Khadamat public-services app on a second mobile platform, after an Android release at the end of August. It is reached through the e-Houwiya digital identity and covers civil-status records, driving licence and vehicle data, traffic fines, inspection bookings, health-insurance and social-security services and e-payments. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Home Affairs to digitise asylum applications to speed up processing** — SAnews (South African Government News Agency), 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's home affairs minister said a biometric online platform for asylum applications is to be operating by 10 November 2026, checking applicants' biometrics against earlier rejected claims and verifying their travel documents. He put the backlog of asylum appeals at about 120,000, a figure he said would be confirmed. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **ADMINISTRATION – Le site de demande de passeport en ligne en cours de test, selon le ministère en charge du Développement numérique** — 2424.mg, 11 October 2026 MADAGASCAR

  Madagascar's digital ministry said its online passport application portal is being tested. Applicants will be able to file, pay and track a first application, renewal or replacement online, while biometric capture and signature remain in person; no launch date was given. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **TASIS outlines governance plans for 24 million Sudanese** — The Sudan Times, 12 October 2026 SUDAN

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- **Government to seek court guidance on asylum ruling, introduce registration system** — SAnews (South African Government News Agency), 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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- **Government to amend regulations to prevent traffic documents being used as identification** — SAnews (South African Government News Agency), 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **Department to scrap use of drivers' licences as ID** — eNCA, 11 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Airtel Money begins trading on London Stock Exchange after an oversubscribed IPO** — The Financial Express, 12 October 2026 AFRICA

  Airtel Money began conditional trading on the London Stock Exchange on 9 October after an oversubscribed offer in which existing shareholders sold 270 million shares, raising about US$703 million. The shares ended just below the offer price on the first day, and unconditional dealings were due on 14 October. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **How scammers are stealing from Ugandans** — The EastAfrican, 11 October 2026 UGANDA

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

Registries

- **LESOTHO GOVERNMENT IS POISED TO BENEFIT SIGNIFICANTLY FROM WORLD BANK AS IT'S ON A VITAL MISSION TO TACKLE YOUTH UNEMPLOYMENT THROUGH INNOVATIVE DIGITAL PUBLIC WORKS PROGRAMS. - Government of Lesotho** — Government of Lesotho, 12 October 2026 LESOTHO

  A World Bank urban and land team told Lesotho's communications ministry it is interested in supporting a nationwide digital address system, in talks that also covered geospatial data for planning and digital public works for young people. No commitment or amount was stated.

- **Will postcode be the next national digital rail after NIN, BVN and NIBSS?** — The Guardian Nigeria, 11 October 2026 NIGERIA

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Sectoral management information systems

- **Key Ration Card Services Now Available on Digital Egypt** — SceneNow, 12 October 2026 EGYPT

  Egypt has put key ration card services on the Digital Egypt platform: heads of household can update card data, replace or activate cards, transfer a file between governorates and add family members. The data-update service is being introduced in Port Said for an initial three months before other governorates. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Beyond the Pinpoints: Making Disability Services Visible in Zanzibar** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP Tanzania), 12 October 2026 TANZANIA

  UNDP says a tool it piloted in Unguja to map disability care and support services has been integrated into Zanzibar's Jumuishi management information system. The mapping found 32 providers, 30 of them in one region. *Also under Access to services.*

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **GBB Promises to Increase Numbers of Digitalised MDA's from Current 30, Says Adeyanju** — ThisDay, 11 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's state network operator said more than 30 federal ministries, departments and agencies have moved onto one platform for paperless approval of documents and memos, and promised wider adoption. It gave no list of agencies and no target; customers at the same event pressed for faster complaint handling.

- **한국 해외원조인데...코이카, 디지털 ODA로 중국 IT장비 지원** — Yonhap News Agency (연합뉴스), 12 October 2026 SENEGAL CAMEROON RWANDA EGYPT

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Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

- **Botswana invests in highway connectivity** — ITWeb Africa, 12 October 2026 BOTSWANA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Technology

AI

- **Zambia Pilots AI Career Guidance Platform to Bridge Youth Skills Gap** — Tech Africa News, 12 October 2026 ZAMBIA

  Zambia's technology ministry is piloting Njila.ai, an artificial-intelligence career-guidance platform, in the technical and vocational training system under a World Bank-backed skills project. The pilot is expected to reach more than 17,000 young people, and feedback is to decide any wider rollout. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **South Sudan calls for digital governance measures at Moscow Forum** — Eye Radio, 12 October 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

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Inclusion

Access to services

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Digital divides

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Geopolitics

China activities

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Digital sovereignty

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.